

C06 HEALTH SERVICES AND BENEFITS | O (MAX : 5 PT)

Intent : Support the overall health and well-being of individuals and their families by offering comprehensive health benefits, policies and services.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to provide access to essential and on-demand health services, paid sick leave and immunizations.

Issue : Access to basic healthcare services is one of five key pillars that form the social determinants of health.¹ Access includes physical or geographic access, affordability, and quality or acceptability of care, and access varies based on race, ethnicity, socioeconomic status, age, sex, disability status, sexual orientation, gender identity and location.²⁻⁵ Unvaccinated individuals pose a risk to public health, and seasonal flu causes severe illness and death in high-risk populations, costing the \$10.4 billion in annual healthcare costs; the average hospitalized flu case in Canada costs \$11,092.⁶⁻⁹ Delays between identifying a need for care and receiving services can increase complications, costs and hospitalization.^{4,10} Moreover, while 94% of the world's countries mandate paid sick leave, the U.S. and Korea are the only OECD countries that do not, and 40% of American employees have no sick leave.^{11,12} Studies estimate that 20 million Americans and 37% of employees in the United Kingdom go to work sick because they lack sick leave or have only one-day sick leave, respectively, infecting colleagues as a result.^{13,14} Employees may also go into work when sick if their sick leave does not offer sufficient wage replacement.¹³

Solutions : Basic essential healthcare services include medical, dental, vision, mental health, substance use, preventive screenings, disease management and biometric assessments.⁴ Providing free on-site flu vaccines with education on good health habits can increase vaccination rates and reduce flu cases.¹⁵ Providing timely access to health services can relieve both actual and perceived barriers to care.^{4,16} Studies demonstrate that the overwhelming majority of employees seek one-on-one benefits consultation and flexible coverage options so they can opt into coverage that best meets their individual schedule and health needs.¹⁷ Studies also show that implementing paid sick leave reduces contagion in the workplace, improves employee productivity and reduces employee turnover.^{13,14,18-20} Overall, enhancing access to essential healthcare and paid sick leave can help improve the physical, social and mental health of individuals and communities.^{2,4}

PART 1 PROMOTE HEALTH BENEFITS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

A health benefits policy meets the following requirements:

- a. Is available to all eligible employees and their designated dependents (e.g., spouse, domestic partner, child) at no cost or subsidized that includes the following services:
 1. Medical care.
 2. Dental care.
 3. Vision care.
 4. Sexual and reproductive health services, including obstetrics and gynecology (OB-GYN) services and sexually transmitted infection (STI) testing and treatment.
 5. Medication/prescription coverage.
 6. Essential immunizations, as determined based on region.
 7. Preventive screenings and biometric assessments.
 8. Tobacco cessation programs.
 9. Infectious disease testing (e.g., tuberculosis, malaria, COVID-19) during a regional or global infectious disease outbreak, epidemic or pandemic as declared by a regional or global public health agency (e.g., WHO, disease control and prevention centers or equivalent).
- b. Confidential benefits consultations are available with clearly identified and qualified support staff (e.g., benefits counselor, human resources representative).

PART 2 OFFER ON-DEMAND HEALTH SERVICES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

A health benefits policy is available for all eligible employees that provides health services at no cost or subsidized, on-site and in-person within 400 m of the project boundary or through a telemedicine provider or digital health platform. The health services program meets the following requirements:

- a. Experienced and qualified healthcare providers (e.g., physician, nurse practitioner, physician assistant) are available to provide confidential medical treatment for episodic, recurrent, urgent or other illnesses before, during and/or after regular business hours.
- b. A scheduling system that allows drop-ins and/or appointment booking.
- c. Eligible employees are permitted to use services during the workday if appointments are only available during regular business hours.

PART 3 OFFER SICK LEAVE (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

A sick leave policy that meets the following requirements is available to all eligible employees:

- a. Leave is offered upfront or accrued for use during any 12-month period for any health condition and meets one of the following requirements:
 1. Short-term sick leave for all eligible employees, distinct from paid time off and family leave, at least 10 days of which are paid at 50% or higher of the employee's full salary or wages.
 2. At least 20 days of combined paid time off and sick leave, which are paid at 50% or higher of the employee's

full salary or wages. Projects using a blended policy are not eligible to pursue Feature M06 Part 1.

- b. Statement that discourages employees from coming into work when they feel sick and from doing work while on sick leave.
- c. At least one of the following:
 - 1. At least 12 weeks of sick leave (which may be unpaid) during any 12-month period for a chronic or serious health condition that involves inpatient care in a hospice or residential healthcare facility (e.g., stroke, infectious disease, surgery) or a health condition that requires continuing treatment and/or supervision by a healthcare provider (e.g., diabetes, asthma, cancer).
 - 2. Part-time options, flexible schedules or permission to work from home when recovering from serious health conditions.

PART 4 SUPPORT COMMUNITY IMMUNITY (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project identifies an immunization relevant to the target population and implements an immunization program which includes the following:

- a. Makes the immunization available to regular occupants on at least an annual basis at no cost through either:
 - 1. An on-site clinic or program.¹⁵
 - 2. An off-site clinic or program (e.g., free community clinic, access through health care providers) and, for employees (as applicable), paid time during the workday to receive the immunization.²¹
- b. For employees, as applicable, at least one day of paid leave for recovery or sick leave following immunization.
- c. A campaign that addresses the following:¹⁵
 - 1. Provides regular occupants information on how the project facilitates immunization availability.
 - 2. Encourages or incentivizes, through monetary or non-monetary methods, regular occupants to receive the immunization.
 - 3. Educates regular occupants on the health reasons to receive the immunization.

PART 5 B PROVIDE ENHANCED HEALTH BENEFITS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

A health benefits policy is available for all eligible employees and their designated dependents (e.g., spouse, domestic partner, child) at no cost or subsidized. Health services must include at least four of the following:

- a. Nutrition support and services (e.g., medical nutrition therapy including nutrition supplements and enteral nutrition).²²⁻²⁴
- b. Complementary and integrative healthcare services (e.g., herbal therapy, mind and body practices such as acupuncture, massage, yoga, aquatic therapy).
- c. Non-Emergency Medical Transportation (NEMT) that includes reimbursable transportation both to and from medical appointments, utilizing a form of transportation that meets the medical needs of the individual and covering all associated expenses.²⁵
- d. Elder care, including home health care.
- e. Fertility Services (e.g., in vitro fertilization, iatrogenic infertility).
- f. Doula or other birth support workers.
- g. Comprehensive Abortion Care (CAC).
- h. Gender-affirming care including, at a minimum, hormone therapy and surgery.

Note :

This part is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.

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